



Project Title: Rise & Shine Interview Series

Project Lead: Robel Adugna

Project Format:

- oral interviews with digitised transcription/summaries and short videos (documentary style)

Introduction:

The "Rise and Shine Series" is an enlightening interview series that aims to amplify the diverse and compelling voices of Ethiopian and Eritrean youth. This project seeks to foster understanding, celebrate shared cultural heritage, and explore the unique stories, aspirations, and challenges that shape the lives of young individuals from these vibrant communities. We will use this platform to showcase the rich cultural tapestry of Ethiopian and Eritrean youth, celebrating the unique traditions that define our community and creating a platform for open and authentic conversations by sharing personal narratives, and building bridges of understanding and solidarity. This interview series will empower young individuals by providing a space for them to express their perspectives, aspirations, and experiences while highlighting the resilience, creativity, and innovation that characterise the youth in our community. We will be challenging stereotypes and misconceptions by presenting a diverse range of stories that reflect the complexity and depth of Ethiopian and Eritrean youth experiences which include stories of remarkable achievements, community initiatives, and personal triumphs to inspire and motivate other youth by providing our audience with role models and inspiration. Throughout this interview series, we hope to interview a wide variety of individuals with different stories and perspectives to share, including newcomers, political leaders, entrepreneurs, musicians, community leaders, athletes, public servants and more! The goals and objectives of CANConnect and the GLOCAL Foundation are accurately depicted in this initiative, specifically its program objectives of inclusivity and community service, civic knowledge mobilisation, civic awareness and democratic literacy, and empowerment through digital civic engagement. The conversations and interviews taking place will impart knowledge, skills, and lessons learned through hands-on experience on the audience. Furthermore, given the fact that our guests will be from different backgrounds, this will allow our audience to relate to the interview, be inspired, and possibly in their footsteps. Civic engagement often begins with awareness and this interview can raise awareness about

issues in our community, encouraging listeners to become more knowledgeable and engaged in their community, workplace or industry. Interviews with community leaders, activists, and ordinary citizens can shed light on local issues and initiatives. This not only brings attention to community needs but also inspires listeners to actively participate in local civic activities. Interviews provide a platform for open dialogues and debates, fostering a culture of constructive discourse. Engaging discussions can encourage listeners to think critically about different viewpoints and consider multiple sides of an issue. Interviews create a sense of community among listeners who share common civic interests, especially interviews targeted at younger audiences, which can be even more effective in promoting civic engagement. This community building can lead to collective action, where engaged citizens work together to address shared concerns.

Project Goals:

Clearly define the specific goals and outcomes you intend to accomplish. These goals should be measurable, time-bound, and aligned with the overall objective of the project.

The primary goal of this project is to conduct interviews that showcase the diverse perspectives, experiences, and achievements of Ethiopian and Eritrean youth. We hope to produce a series of 7 interviews from January to March 2024 (program timeline) and have the final products posted on our social media channels by the end of the program timeline. Additionally, we hope to use this platform to encourage civic engagement and community involvement among Ethiopian and Eritrean youth by conducting interviews that discuss community initiatives, volunteerism, and opportunities for youth to make a positive impact.

Another goal of the project is to promote cross-cultural understanding by highlighting commonalities and differences among Ethiopian and Eritrean youth by including interviews that discuss shared cultural values, aspirations, and challenges faced by both communities. Over the course of the project timeline, we hope to interview 7 youth from different disciplines or industries (music, restaurant, entrepreneurship, community service, real estate etc.) to provide the audience with diverse subject matter but discussing that subject through a cultural lens.

We also hope to provide inspiration and empowerment to Ethiopian and Eritrean youth through interviews with successful role models and influencers. Our interviewees will share their success stories and obstacles they've overcome throughout their journey. Everyone's journey is different so success is relative.

At the end of the project, a sense of community among Ethiopian and Eritrean youth will be created by facilitating engagement and interaction. This sense of community will be fostered by a family-friendly interview style with informal questions, interactive icebreakers, getting the community to ask questions in advance of the interview and we plan to incorporate these elements throughout the 4 months.

Debunking stereotypes, amplifying positive narratives and providing the community with examples of role models and inspirations is another critical goal of this project. We hope to include at least 4 stories of instances where the guest turned tragedy into triumph/rags to riches to highlight positive contributions, achievements, and innovations within the community.

Methods and Strategies:

The overarching framework for our youth interview series, spanning from January 15 to March 15, is strategically designed to achieve a set of well-defined project goals. Our primary approach centres around inclusivity, cross-cultural exploration, inspiration, community engagement, and the amplification of positive narratives. To elevate youth voices from the Ethiopian and Eritrean communities, we plan to engage with a diverse group of individuals, creating an inclusive space for them to share their unique stories and perspectives. The rationale behind this approach is rooted in the belief that a multitude of voices contributes to a richer and more nuanced narrative, fostering a sense of community and representation. By emphasising cross-cultural themes in our interviews, we aim to break down stereotypes and nurture a deeper understanding between the two communities, aligning with our objective to foster cross-cultural understanding.

The strategy to empower and inspire youth involves featuring interviews with successful role models and influencers. These narratives of resilience and personal growth are intended to serve as tangible examples, inspiring the youth audience to pursue their goals. This approach aligns with our broader objective of empowering the next generation by providing relatable and motivational stories. Simultaneously, we plan to encourage civic engagement by highlighting community initiatives led by Ethiopian and Eritrean youth, thereby illustrating the power of collective action. This strategy aims to instil a sense of social responsibility and active participation within the communities. Building a connected community is an integral part of our approach, achieved through the implementation of interactive elements like live Q&A sessions and audience polls. This fosters a two-way communication channel, transforming the interview series into a collaborative experience and enhancing the sense of connection among the youth.

Amplifying positive narratives serves as a counterbalance to prevalent negative stereotypes. By showcasing positive contributions, achievements, and innovations within the Ethiopian and Eritrean youth communities, our strategy aims to reshape public perceptions and instil a sense of pride and self-worth among the youth. Overall, our chosen methods and strategies are meticulously aligned with our project goals, creating a comprehensive and cohesive framework. The combination of inclusive storytelling, cross-cultural exploration, inspirational content, and community engagement seeks to achieve a meaningful and impactful experience for both the participants and the audience. This holistic approach ensures that each element contributes to the overarching objective of fostering connection, understanding, and empowerment within the Ethiopian and Eritrean youth communities.

Activities and Tasks:

Break down your project into specific activities and tasks. Provide a detailed description of each activity, including what needs to be done, who will be responsible, and the estimated timeframe. Ensure that the activities are logically sequenced and consider any dependencies between tasks.

There will be two project coordinators leading this initiative, Robel and Orit. In the beginning, both will meet together to confirm roles and responsibilities (as outlined in this document), goals and objectives, deliverables and deadlines and other key pieces of information needed to make this project a success.

Out of the 7 interviews, Robel will be in charge of recruiting 4 and Orit will be in charge of recruiting the remaining 3. Additionally, Robel will be in charge of interviewing the 4 guests he has recruited and Orit will be in charge of interviewing the 3 guests she has recruited. Next, we will each be responsible for scheduling the interview of the guests we've recruited, however it will be very important and beneficial that everyone is present for all interviews. Once the schedule is confirmed, we will then look for available spaces to conduct the interviews and begin outlining the footage we need for the video. Microphones will be picked up the day before to limit costs as most places charge per day and lunch will be picked up during the day of the interview. Both tasks will be done by Robel as he will have access to a car. We hope to ask each guest 15 to 20 questions with the interview itself not lasting more than an hour, with a small break in between for lunch. The questions will be reviewed by the coordinators before each interview to ensure a smooth flow, open ended and non-invasive questions, and interest.

After the interview is conducted, we will then move on to the next phase, obtaining b-roll footage and photography for the short video. Ideally, this would take place on the same day of the interview but if that is not possible, then we can take notes of the places we'd have to visit and visit them on another day.

After each interview, one project coordinator would then start preparing for the next interview and the other would start transcribing important quotes and answers from the interview. Simultaneously, the photographer/editor would be editing the footage from the latest interview until it's time to record footage for the next interview. This phase would be repeated after each interview. Also after each interview, the budget will be monitored to ensure we have not been overspending and to update our file of receipts and payments. Robel will be responsible for managing the finances for this project.

Once all the interviews are conducted, and all the videos are finished, they will be periodically uploaded to our social media platforms by Robel.

At the end of the project, Robel will administer the payments to the photographers and work closely with Orit on the final report, and post-project survey.

Implementation Plan:

1. Project Kickoff (January 15 - January 21)

Tasks:

- Finalise project goals and objectives.
- Confirm interview themes and topics.
- Develop interviewee outreach strategy.
- Establish a production schedule.

Milestone:

- Completion of project kickoff tasks by January 21.

Potential Risks and Contingency:

- Risk: Delays in finalising project goals.
- Contingency: Allocate additional time for goal finalisation while ensuring other tasks proceed as scheduled.

2. Pre-production Phase (January 22 - January 31)

Tasks:

- Identify and contact potential interviewees.
- Develop interview scripts and questions.
- Set up recording and production equipment.
- Create promotional materials.

Milestones:

- Confirmation of interviewees by January 25.
- Completion of interview scripts by January 28.
- Equipment setup and testing by January 30.

Potential Risks and Contingency:

- Risk: Difficulty in securing interviewees.
- Contingency: Expand outreach efforts, consider alternative candidates.

3. Episode Production (February 1 - February 28)

Tasks:

- Conduct interviews with selected youth.
- Record additional footage for visual content.
- Begin initial editing for the first set of episodes.
- Implement interactive elements for audience engagement.

Milestones:

- Completion of interviews by February 15.
- Initial editing and visual content recording by February 22.
- Testing of interactive elements by February 28.

Potential Risks and Contingency:

- Risk: Technical issues during recording.
- Contingency: Have backup recording equipment, conduct technical rehearsals.

4. Mid-Project Review (March 1 - March 3)

Tasks:

- Evaluate progress against established KPIs.
- Collect audience feedback on initial episodes.
- Make any necessary adjustments to the content or engagement strategies.

Milestones:

- Collection of audience feedback by March 2.
- Adjustment plan developed by March 3.

Potential Risks and Contingency:

- Risk: Low audience engagement.
- Contingency: Introduce new promotional strategies, enhance interactive elements.

5. Episode Finalisation (March 4 - March 7)

Tasks:

- Complete editing and post-production for all episodes.
- Develop promotional content for upcoming releases.
- Ensure the consistency of branding across all materials.

Milestones:

- Final episode edits by March 6.
- Completion of promotional content by March 7.

Potential Risks and Contingency:

- Risk: Unexpected delays in editing.
- Contingency: Allocate additional resources, consider outsourcing editing.

6. Marketing and Promotion (March 8 - March 14)

Tasks:

- Launch promotional campaigns on social media platforms.
- Collaborate with influencers and partners for increased reach.
- Schedule interviews with media outlets for additional promotion.
- Encourage audience participation through contests or challenges.

Milestones:

- Launch of promotional campaigns by March 10.
- Interviews scheduled with media outlets by March 12.

Potential Risks and Contingency:

- Risk: Insufficient media coverage.
- Contingency: Increase outreach efforts, explore additional media partnerships.

7. Project Conclusion and Evaluation (March 15)

Tasks:

- Release the final set of episodes.
- Conduct a comprehensive evaluation of the project's success.
- Analyse final KPIs and compare against initial goals.
- Prepare a final report summarising the project, outcomes, and lessons learned.

Milestones:

- Release of final episodes on March 15.
- Completion of project evaluation and final report by March 20.

Potential Risks and Contingency:

- Risk: Low audience satisfaction.
- Contingency: Gather additional feedback, plan for follow-up content or improvements.

By following this detailed implementation plan, we aim to ensure a smooth and successful execution of the youth interview series, with built-in checkpoints and contingency plans to address potential risks or challenges that may arise during the project timeline.

Resource Allocation:

Discuss the resources required to execute your project successfully. This may include personnel, budget, equipment, or any other necessary resources.

The staff will receive their honoraria at the end of the project which is essentially once the final video has been uploaded and the final report has been submitted. The interviewees will receive their honoraria plus transportation reimbursement once they have completed their interview and all necessary footage and video content has been obtained. The spaces will be rented in advance of the interview to ensure availability. Once we book the date and time for the interview which should be no later than late July, the spaces will be reserved. To limit rental costs, as most places charge per day, we will rent the audio equipment no more than a day before the scheduled interview. The lunch will be purchased the day of the interview to ensure freshness and proper sanitation.

Monitoring and Evaluation:

Explain how you will monitor the progress of your project and evaluate its success. Identify key performance indicators (KPIs) or metrics that will be used to measure the achievement of project goals. Describe the monitoring tools or methods you will utilise and how often progress reports will be generated.

Monitoring the progress and evaluating the success of our youth interview series is crucial to ensuring that we are meeting our objectives and making a positive impact on our target audience. We will utilise key performance indicators (KPIs) and employ various monitoring tools and methods.

One way to measure the success of the interviews and short films is to monitor audience engagement through social media metrics, including likes, shares, comments, views and follower growth. We will be regularly monitoring social media platforms where the series is promoted like Instagram, Facebook and our website and assess audience interaction with the content.

Another way to measure the success of the project is through the diversity of our guests and subject matter. We will maintain a database to track the key points of the interview and of the interviewee to ensure a diverse range of perspectives is consistently represented and to ensure a variety of youth voices are featured in the interviews, promoting representation of the different ethnicities, backgrounds, and experiences within our community.

At the end of the project, we will implement surveys and community feedback mechanisms to collect information on tangible outcomes resulting from the series to record the number of community initiatives, projects and even ideas inspired by the interview series. The surveys will not only be sent out to the community but to the interviewees as well, in hopes to gain further insight into their experience with the project. The first 20 respondents to the survey will be put in a draw to win a gift to be chosen at a later date. The survey will be posted on our social media platforms with surrounding promotion.

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Tasks:

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Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) to Monitor:

1. Social Media Engagement: Monitor likes, shares, comments, and follower growth on social media platforms.
2. Audience Reach: Track viewership statistics on hosting platforms (YouTube, podcast directories).
3. Diversity of Voices: Record and analyse the demographics of interviewees for diversity.
4. Interactive Participation: Measure participation rates in live sessions and interactive elements.
5. Community Impact: Document and assess the number of community initiatives inspired by the series.
6. Positive Narratives Amplification: Analyse audience sentiment through comments and feedback.

Monitoring Tools and Methods:

1. Social Media Analytics: Utilise platform-specific analytics tools.
2. Web Analytics: Employ website analytics tools.
3. Surveys and Feedback Forms: Distribute online surveys to the audience.
4. Interviewee Database: Maintain a centralised database to track information.
5. Sentiment Analysis Tools: Implement sentiment analysis tools for online feedback.

Frequency of Progress Reports:

Regular progress reports will be generated bi-weekly throughout the production and promotional phases. These reports will include updates on KPIs, adjustments made to the content or engagement strategies, and any emerging trends or insights. The mid-project review will offer a comprehensive assessment, and the final report will summarise the project's overall success and impact.

Conclusion:

The project kicks off with the finalisation of goals and themes, followed by a proactive pre-production phase to secure diverse interviewees, develop scripts, and set up recording equipment. The production phase includes conducting interviews, recording visual content, and testing interactive elements. A mid-project review assesses progress, collects feedback, and allows for adjustments. Finalization involves completing editing, developing promotional content, and ensuring brand consistency. The marketing and promotion phase, leading up to the project's conclusion on March 15, involves extensive outreach, media collaboration, and audience engagement.

The project employs a multifaceted approach to achieve its goals. To elevate youth voices, a diverse range of participants is engaged, fostering inclusivity. Cross-cultural understanding is facilitated through interviews emphasising shared experiences. Inspirational narratives empower the youth, while highlighting community initiatives encourages civic engagement. Building a connected community involves interactive elements for audience participation, and amplifying positive narratives counters stereotypes, fostering pride.

The project aims to create a nuanced narrative that elevates and empowers Ethiopian and Eritrean youth. By fostering cross-cultural understanding, encouraging civic engagement, and building a connected community, the series seeks to instil a sense of pride, possibility, and social responsibility. Amplifying positive narratives intends to reshape public perceptions and combat stereotypes. The final project evaluation will measure success against key performance indicators, including social media engagement, audience reach, diversity of voices, interactive participation, community impact, and positive narratives.

This interview series is not merely a collection of stories; it's a purposeful initiative to amplify voices, bridge cultural gaps, and inspire action. We are committed to executing this project with precision, emphasising authenticity, diversity, and engagement. The significance of fostering connection, understanding, and empowerment within the Ethiopian and Eritrean youth communities underscores our commitment to creating a meaningful and lasting impact. Through strategic implementation, inclusive storytelling, and community collaboration, we look forward to a successful project that resonates with our audience and contributes positively to the narrative of these vibrant communities.

Thanks,
Robel Adugna

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